Module 13: How Populations Evolve - Practice Quiz

Use this low-stakes quiz after reviewing the module keys and learning questions.

1. Microevolution is defined as:
2. A. the origin of entirely new kingdoms of life
3. B. a change in allele frequencies in a population over generations
4. C. a change in a single individual's body
5. D. the extinction of every species
6. Answer: B

7. Why: Microevolution is a shift in allele frequencies within a population over time.

8. Genetic drift has its strongest effect in:

9. A. small populations
10. B. very large populations
11. C. populations with no variation
12. D. populations that never reproduce
13. Answer: A

14. Why: Random sampling changes allele frequencies most strongly when the population is small.

15. A few birds colonize a new island and start a population with limited variation. This reduced variation is due to:

16. A. natural selection alone
17. B. gene flow between islands
18. C. mutation pressure
19. D. the founder effect
20. Answer: D

21. Why: The founder effect is genetic drift that occurs when a new population begins from only a few individuals.

22. The Hardy-Weinberg principle is useful mainly because it:

23. A. proves evolution never happens
24. B. measures average body size
25. C. provides a non-evolving baseline to compare real populations against
26. D. edits alleles directly
27. Answer: C
28. Why: Hardy-Weinberg describes allele frequencies with no evolution. Deviations from it signal that evolutionary forces are at work.